Philipp Hilbert. *Execution-first product operator for D2C subscription products.*

Positioning, ten years closing the gap between priority and shipped, verified release, across defence AI, health data, SaaS, and zero-to-one products.

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§ WHY RUBY LABS

Ruby Labs runs live D2C subscription products where execution quality directly drives revenue, a context where "almost done" genuinely costs money. The posting is explicit that this role closes gaps itself rather than waiting for assignment, and that the bar is set by verified releases, not by tickets marked done. That matches how I have operated at Rohde & Schwarz, where I owned a defence AI pipeline from broken rollout to a fully hotfix-capable, 30-minute deploy cycle, and at EMIL Group, where I restructured a 17-person team mid-flight to restore delivery pace. The requirement for daily AI-tool use across spec writing, QA, and analysis is the working mode I already default to. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case walkthroughs
- **GitHub Copilot**, developer-side review and task scoping
- **Lovable**, clickable prototypes before a sprint begins
- **GPT**, first-draft acceptance criteria and QA checklists
- **Framer**, design-review and flow-validation artifacts
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation for recurring delivery tasks
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready status reporting at speed

- **Cursor / VSCode**, reading implementation context before writing specs

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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Shopware, WhatsApp and Telegram messaging APIs, LLM agent frameworks, Jira, Confluence, Linear-equivalent backlog tooling.

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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RUBY LABS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Audit the live backlog end to end, read every open ticket, tag what is developer-ready versus what is missing acceptance criteria or edge-case coverage, and produce a written gap map shared with the Managing Director before day eight.

WEEK 2

Tighten and standardise.

Introduce a definition of done and a spec template the engineering team actually uses, validated by running the next sprint's tasks through it and measuring back-and-forth volume against the baseline.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Take ownership of the first unowned initiative, drive it to verified release, and run a retro that converts any miss into a documented process change rather than a one-time fix.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Ruby Labs team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role because the accountability structure you describe is the one I have built my career around. At Rohde & Schwarz, the FCAS defence AI data platform had rollout cycles that ran for days and no reliable hotfix path. I took end-to-end ownership: defined acceptance criteria for each pipeline stage, pushed the team to treat a release as unfinished until it passed verification, and rebuilt the delivery pipeline until rollouts ran in 30 minutes and were fully hotfix-capable. That is the shape of work you are describing, and it is the shape of work I seek out.

The requirement to write technical tasks that engineers execute without back-and-forth is something I treat as a professional standard, not a nice-to-have. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I owned a large ETL migration and a UI relaunch simultaneously. The team was distributed and the delivery surface was wide. Precise specs with measurable acceptance criteria and explicit edge cases were the only thing that kept both tracks moving without constant re-work. At CLINET, I went further and integrated the CGM/KIS clinical interface myself, which gave me the fluency to write implementation-level tasks without engineering translation overhead.

I use AI tools daily across the full delivery cycle: Claude Code for spec generation and edge-case walkthroughs, GitHub Copilot for reading implementation context before writing tasks, Lovable for clickable prototypes that resolve flow disputes before they enter the backlog, and GPT for first-draft QA checklists. The result is that a disputed flow becomes a validated artifact in a day rather than a multi-meeting debate. I also run agent-based automation for recurring delivery tasks via n8n, which reduces coordination overhead and surfaces blockers earlier.

On cross-functional ownership and unowned projects: at EMIL Group, a 17-person team had lost delivery pace and coherence. I restructured it into three smaller teams with explicit leads, defined ownership per workstream, and launched the Claims Center product. The structural problem was the root cause; I fixed the structure rather than adding process on top of dysfunction. That bias toward root-cause repair over workaround is what the Ruby Labs posting describes when it asks for someone who identifies bottlenecks and fixes them with structure.

Ruby Labs operates in the D2C subscription space, where retention and conversion quality are directly affected by delivery quality. I understand that context, and I am ready to hold the bar you describe, clear tickets, honest timelines, and work verified against spec before it ships.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

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§ BEARING

Ten years of product ownership across regulated enterprise software, defence AI, public data platforms, and zero-to-one consumer products. I take end-to-end delivery accountability, from backlog prioritisation to verified release, and repair process gaps structurally rather than through heroics. My operating mode is AI-first: I accelerate spec writing, QA, and analysis with daily tool use and spread what works across the team. I am drawn to high-accountability contexts where execution quality is the competitive variable.

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§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product craft. Continuous discovery, backlog and release ownership, sprint discipline, definition-of-done design, outcome negotiation with stakeholders, SAFe PI planning, metric definition before build.

AI-first building. Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Lovable for full prototyping, GPT, Framer, n8n agent workflows, Gamma.app; I own production-grade results without writing the code.

Data and AI platforms. ETL orchestration and migration, analytics platforms for public use, multimodal AI training data pipelines. Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt, LLM agents.

Cloud, delivery and operations. Bare-metal to container migration, rollout and hotfix pipelines, GitOps. Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Integration and platforms. Clinical interfaces (CGM/KIS), payment and forecourt systems, e-commerce platforms (Shopware), messaging APIs (WhatsApp, Telegram).

Regulated environments. Defence, public sector, health data and insurance: identity management, audit and governance cycles, highest privacy requirements.

Working tools: Jira, Confluence, Linear-equivalent tooling.

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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE, B2B SAAS 2025 TO NOW

Zero-to-one AI-assisted operations; built agent-backed workflows via WhatsApp and Telegram APIs to automate coordination between trades and project leads.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM (FCAS), B2B SAAS 2024 TO 2025

Owned multimodal AI data pipeline end to end; cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes, made the product fully hotfix-capable, and steered it from UI-heavy to dev-code-friendly. Kafka, Kotlin, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023 TO 2024

Delivered bare-metal-to-container migration, UI relaunch, and large ETL migration concurrently; public labour-market data made searchable, filterable, and social-media-ready. Dagster, dbt.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURTECH LOW-CODE SAAS 2022

Launched Claims Center; restructured a 17-person team into three focused teams with dedicated leads to restore delivery pace and accountability.

CLINET · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH-TECH MOBILE APP 2021 TO 2022

Native iOS/Android app; integrated the CGM/KIS clinical interface directly, enabling precise implementation-level spec writing without translation overhead.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM (RKI) 2021

Owned RKI projects DIM and DESH: vaccination statistics and viral-mutation tracking under highest privacy and identity-management standards.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · FUEL-RETAIL INTEGRATION 2020 TO 2021

POS, payment, and forecourt systems; delivery via SAFe PI planning and release trains.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · PROCUREMENT PLATFORM 2019 TO 2020

Full migration of a legacy webshop to Shopware for approximately 20,000 users.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · IT MODERNISATION, WIND ENERGY 2019

Full-site modernisation across end devices, servers, switches, lines, and software.

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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

Kvitt (mobile payments, acquired by Sparkasse) · **Qcrypt** (quantum-resistant encryption, Product Owner) · **Smart Soil Technologies** (nanotech)

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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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